MATTHEW BATCHELDOR

Strategic Partnerships | Commercial Growth | Go-to-Market

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PROFILE

Strategic partnerships and commercial growth leader across digital media, platforms and agencies. Led a winning regional advertising pitch in Australia and jointly closed a sales-linked sponsorship in Japan.

CORE EXPERTISE

Strategic partnerships | Joint business planning | Enterprise business development | Go-to-market strategy | Sponsorship | YouTube and audience growth | Paid media and measurement | Team leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Partnerships Director — **May 2025 - July 2026**

Uchi Japan | Remote, independent contractor

- Jointly closed the Hotel101 Niseko partnership, combining production, promotion, sponsorship and developer listings, with commission linked to sales of Hotel101 Happy Rooms.
- Helped grow Uchi's YouTube channel to 117,000 subscribers and 6.7M+ views across 700+ videos. Collaborated on original films, including I Love Niseko.

General Manager, Operations — **June 2024 - May 2025**

Watch This, New Zealand | Remote contract

- Led the winning Luv-a-Duck pitch, securing an A$2m regional test budget in Australia. The YouTube plan used Google Ads Reach Planner forecasts for Sydney, Brisbane and Adelaide.
- The team extended campaign reach by coordinating YouTube media buying with TV, radio and billboard spend. It filmed bespoke YouTube content for Christmas, Easter and summer as part of a year-round content calendar.
- Expanded the agency's offer into YouTube and branded entertainment, developing the YouTube proposition with Momentum Group alongside the agency's Meta and TikTok work.
- Joined the leadership team at launch, worked closely with the CEO and CMO, and helped build the agency's commercial and operating model. Led a five-person remote team with four direct reports across social strategy, creative production, paid media and client delivery. Oversaw the Salesforce-tracked commercial pipeline.

Co-Founder, Director & Managing Partner — **March 2021 - July 2023**

Smart Media Agency, New Zealand

- Led new business, commercial strategy and client relationships for accounts with NZ$500K to NZ$5M media budgets.
- Introduced a transparent media buying model that delivered reported client media cost savings of up to 40%.
- Secured platform accreditation and developed commercial relationships across programmatic, search, social and YouTube. Managed four to five direct reports and 15 contract specialists.

Strategy Director & Business Development — **August 2019 - July 2020**

Momentum Media (formerly Point Media), New Zealand

- Led business development and media strategy, contributing to a tripling of agency media billings.
- Led the AA Money client relationship and commercial media strategy, coordinating colleagues on customer acquisition planning and cross-channel delivery.

VOLUNTEER PROJECT

- Supported Alex Gilbert's An Adoption Story through a personal YouTube promotion project in 2024, pairing a promoted Short with the long-form story. YouTube Studio recorded 159,193 channel views in 28 days, 282% above usual.

Google | Auckland and London

Industry Head, Technology, Telecommunications, FMCG & Energy (Large Customer Sales) October 2012 - October 2018

- Grew the annual industry portfolio from around US$2M to more than US$40M through executive joint business plans and go-to-market initiatives. The portfolio generated around US$12M in incremental partnership revenue in 2018.
- Led Spark's executive joint business plan covering NZ$12M+ a year across Search, YouTube, Display and Programmatic.
- Signed and owned Spark's 12-month YouTube Masthead agreement, covering 60 homepage days and coordinating delivery across Spark, its creative and media agencies, and YouTube teams.
- Grew the Xero account from around US$500K to US$3M in 12 months, working with senior global and country marketing leaders.
- Advanced Google Analytics 360 adoption in telecommunications and energy accounts, from business case to implementation.

Agency Team Lead October 2008 - October 2012

- Led relationships with major agency holding groups in New Zealand across measurement, mobile, video and customer acquisition. Represented Google on the IAB New Zealand Council.

Key Account Manager - New Zealand May 2007 - October 2008

- Opened the New Zealand market as Google's first commercial hire, developing advertiser relationships and winning early national travel and tourism accounts.

Key Account Manager - United Kingdom April 2004 - April 2007

- Managed key London advertiser accounts and participated in product testing after Google acquired Urchin, which became Google Analytics.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Technical Marketing Manager December 2002 - November 2003

The Cloud, London

- Managed BT Openzone deployment across 118 locations and a £2M marketing budget during the early public Wi-Fi rollout.

Travel Category Manager, Customer Champion Lead, Complaints Coordinator November 1999 - November 2002

lastminute.com, London

RECOGNITION

- Google Industry Gold Award, Samsung video effectiveness
- Google Innovation Award, Xero live growth dashboard
- NZDMA Gold Award, Vodafone "Say It Tika"
- Two Silver Beacon Awards, Genesis Energy

EDUCATION

BA (Hons), Biblical Studies | The University of Sheffield

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

UK citizen and Spanish resident | English, native | Open to remote EMEA roles and international travel